

Windows Profile Error Recovery

Issue: "User Profile Service service failed the sign-in" or user is logged into a TEMP profile.
TEMP.DOMAIN.001, .002 folders accumulating in C:\Users.

Decision Tree

```
User reports profile error at login
■■■ Getting a TEMP profile (desktop empty, settings missing)?
■   ■■■ YES → Check C:\Users for TEMP.* folders
■   ■   ■■■ Multiple TEMP folders → FIX A (SID .bak collision)
■   ■   ■■■ One TEMP folder → Does original profile folder exist?
■   ■       ■■■ YES → FIX A
■   ■       ■■■ NO → Profile deleted/corrupted → FIX B
■   ■■■ "User Profile Service failed the sign-in" – can't log in at all
■       ■■■ Can log in as local admin? → FIX A from admin context
■       ■■■ Cannot log in at all → Boot Safe Mode → FIX A
■■■ Happens to ALL domain users on this machine?
■   ■■■ YES → Machine-level issue: check disk space, Default profile integrity
■   ■■■ NO → User-specific SID issue → FIX A
```

FIX A: SID .bak Registry Repair

Fixes 90%+ of TEMP profile cases.

1. Log in as local Administrator.
2. Open **regedit** as Administrator.
3. Navigate to **HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\ProfileList**.
4. Find the affected user's SID. You'll typically see:

```
S-1-5-21-xxx-xxx-xxx-xxxx    ← Points to TEMP path
S-1-5-21-xxx-xxx-xxx-xxxx.bak ← Points to real profile path
```

5. The **.bak** entry is the original. The non-.bak is the failed redirect.
 6. Rename the non-.bak entry → add **.old** suffix.
 7. Rename the .bak entry → remove **.bak** suffix.
 8. In the renamed entry, set **RefCount** to **0** and **State** to **0** (if they exist).
 9. Close regedit.
 10. Delete **C:\Users\TEMP.*** folders (user must be logged off).
 11. Reboot.
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FIX B: Profile Folder Missing

1. Delete the orphaned SID entry from ProfileList (back it up first).
 2. Delete any TEMP folders for that user.
 3. Reboot — Windows creates a fresh profile on next login.
 4. Restore documents from backup if available.
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FIX C: Disk Full Causing Profile Failures

Profile creation fails silently when the drive is full.

```
# Check free space
(Get-PSDrive C).Free / 1GB

# If under 2 GB, free space first
.\Invoke-HelpDeskOrchestrator.ps1 -RelieveDiskPressure -CleanupTemp -DisableHibernation
```

Then proceed with FIX A.

Bulk Cleanup

```
# List TEMP profile folders
Get-ChildItem C:\Users -Directory | Where-Object { $_.Name -match "^TEMP\." }

# Remove them (ensure users are logged off)
Get-ChildItem C:\Users -Directory | Where-Object { $_.Name -match "^TEMP\." } |
    Remove-Item -Recurse -Force -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue
```

Prevention

- Run **-AuditProfileHealth** weekly to catch .bak entries early.
- Maintain minimum 10 GB free on system drives.
- If recurring across multiple machines, investigate domain trust, GPO, or SID replication issues.

Windows Endpoint Remediation Toolkit